

Image 10.1: Map of all the rivers of Indus Basin
Source: Archives of AIM Television Pvt. Ltd.

The treaty signed between India and Pakistan in 1960 divided the Indus and the five rivers of Punjab between the upper riparian state India and the lower riparian state Pakistan. While the waters of the Sutlej, Beas and Ravi went exclusively to India, India is allowed to tap into 19.48 per cent of the run-of-the-river water of the Indus, Chenab and Jhelum that flow through. In fact, when India and Pakistan had six rounds of talks in 1963 to settle the issue of Kashmir, Pakistan demanded 90 per cent of the Buddhist majority Ladakh because the Indus flowed through it. Was the Chinese incursion into Aksai Chin in 1954, Pakistani purchase of Gwadar in 1958, the commencement of the construction of the Karakoram Highway in 1959, the Indus Waters Treaty of 1960, the 1962 war and the Sino-Pak border deal on Shaksgam Valley in 1963, all interconnected milestones in a far-reaching conspiracy to steal India's waters?

The 1,300 km long Karakoram Highway, whose survey work was started in 1959, took 20 years to complete.[15] In between this period, in China, the failure of the Great Leap Forward in 1960 and the effect of the Cultural Revolution from 1966 to 1971 delayed the completion of this